

YSJ 2026: Juniors Yeah!!!!!!

Description:

YSJ's Junior Research Program is a student research program designed to help high school students learn research from choosing a research question to publishing a full paper and become part of a community of passionate researchers.

Throughout the program, participants will have opportunities to:

- Explore the foundations of academic research
- Learn how researchers investigate questions and evaluate evidence
- Engage with peers who share similar academic interests

Selection Criteria

YSJ seeks Juniors with strong potential for growth rather than extensive prior achievements.

When reviewing applications, we place particular emphasis on:

- Intellectual curiosity
- Initiative and self-motivation
- Commitment to learning
- Alignment with the values of the program

Previous research experience **is not required**.

Application Process

The selection process consists of the following stages:

- Stage 1: Application Review
Applicants complete the application form, including written responses designed to help us understand their personalities and experiences.
- Stage 2: Interview
Selected applicants will be invited to an interview where they will discuss their applications.
- Stage 3: Final Decisions
Successful applicants will receive an admission decision following the completion of the selection process.

Terms of Agreement

- Juniors should participate actively in program activities.
- Juniors are expected to be open to feedback from the YSJ Seniors.
- Juniors are required to demonstrate professionalism and respectful communication.
- Juniors should complete assigned tasks and responsibilities on time.
- Juniors are required to demonstrate willingness to collaborate within a team and genuine commitment to the journal's mission.

- Failure to meet set expectations will result in penalties and could lead up to expulsion in case of repetition.
- Juniors are provided with a certificate detailing their progress and the hours committed, along with their performance ratings, at the end of the specified duration (Mid-October 2026).
- **AI usage in any part through the form or during any tasks in case of acceptance will not be tolerated.**

Note: Applications will be reviewed on a rolling basis, so apply now to secure your seat!

DEADLINE: 11th July 2026

* Indicates required question

1. Email *

2. By selecting “Yes, I agree” you confirm that you understand and accept the Terms of Agreement, responsibilities, time commitments, and performance expectations of the Junior Research Program. *

Check all that apply.

☐ Yes, I agree

Personal Information

3. Full Name *

This name will appear in all communications by the journal, including emails, posts, and websites.

4. Personal email adress *

Please ensure the accuracy of your email address as all subsequent communications regarding the application process will be sent to this email. We suggest that you don't use a school or university email address.

5. Phone Number (including country code) *

Example: +20 XXX XXX XXXX

6. Country of Nationality *

7. Gender *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Male

☐ Female

8. Date of Birth *

Example: January 7, 2019

Academic Information

9. School Name *

10. Educational Grade (as of the 2026-2027 Academic Year) *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Grade 10 (High School Sophomore)
- ☐ Grade 11 (High School Junior)
- ☐ Grade 12 (High School Senior)
- ☐ Gap Year Student

11. Your areas of academic interest *

Important: Please carefully select the specific research areas that align with your preferences for consideration upon admission.

Check all that apply.

- ☐ Architecture
- ☐ Astronomy & Astrophysics
- ☐ Biology
- ☐ Business & Economics
- ☐ Chemistry
- ☐ Computer Science
- ☐ Engineering
- ☐ Environmental Studies
- ☐ Mathematics
- ☐ Medicine & Health Sciences
- ☐ Neuroscience
- ☐ Physics
- ☐ Psychology
- ☐ Other: _____

12. Grade of each respective field in previous academic years (if applicable). *

Please also mention the highest value that can be attained (e.g. 3.7/4.0, 92%, etc.)

13. What extracurricular activities and achievements have you pursued in your area of academic interest? *

Please list any relevant courses, certifications, online programs, workshops, bootcamps, or training experiences you have completed (e.g. Anything other than schoolwork). Include a brief description if applicable.

Essay Questions

14. Why do you want to join YSJ Junior, and what do you hope to gain from the experience? *

Please respond in at least 150 words.

15. Tell us about something you learned purely because you were curious, not because it was required for school. What interested you about it, and what did you learn? *

Please respond in 200-300 words.

16. A study finds that students who spend more time reading books tend to earn higher grades. *

Does this mean reading books causes higher grades? Why or why not? What additional information would you want before reaching a conclusion?

Please respond in 250-300 words.

Experience

17. Please describe your research experience. *

This experience does not need to be limited to professional or formal settings. We are looking for evidence of your capacity to learn and engage with research methodologies. You may include independent work, such as writing small articles, analyzing academic papers, participating in research programs and workshops, or any other suitable and meaningful ordeals.

Time Commitments

18. Kindly provide a list of your major academic, professional, or personal commitments between August 2026 and October 2026. For each commitment, please estimate the average number of hours per week you expect to spend on it. *

19. How much time (hours per week) will you be able to commit to YSJ? *

Additional Information

20. Where did you hear about us? *

21. Anything else we should know?

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